

bold approach. Unlike Fawcett's NUWSS, the Suffragettes advocated violence and acts of public disobedience as the only way to draw attention to their cause. Officially, these Suffragettes called themselves the Women's Social and Political Union (WSPU), a group led by Emmeline Pankhurst and her daughters Sylvia, Christabel, and Adela. Ideologically in between the WSPU and NUWSS were other groups, such as the Women's Freedom League, which embraced nonviolent militarism.

The Suffragettes

Emmeline Pankhurst had been involved in the women's suffrage cause since 1880, but believed that the vote would not be won through conventional channels. The WSPU devised a strategy with tactics that included bombing, arson, and chaining themselves to public property. When the Suffragettes were



▲ Honoring hunger

Suffragettes who went on hunger strike in prison were given medals by the WSPU for their bravery. This one belonged to Maud Joachim, the first Scottish hunger striker.

IN BRIEF

SUFFRAGE STRUGGLE

Many women in the West gained the right to vote in the early 20th century, thanks to the efforts of suffrage activists and women's participation in two World Wars.

1800

- **1866** British MP John Mill presents the first women's suffrage petition to the House of Commons.
- **1869** Unmarried British women gain voting rights in local elections. Wyoming becomes the first US state to grant full suffrage to women.
- **1893** New Zealand grants full suffrage to adult European women.

1900

- **1905** The Women's Social and Political Union (WSPU) sanctions militant action.
- **1908** Victoria becomes the last Australian state to give women full voting rights.
- **1910** A bill to give voting rights to any woman with more than £10 in assets fails in the UK.
- **1913** Norway gives women full voting rights.
- **1915** Women in Denmark and Iceland are granted voting rights.
- **1918** In March, 40,000 women take to the streets of St. Petersburg, Russia to demand the right to vote. Women over 20 are granted suffrage by the revolutionary regime in July.
- **1918** Austria and Germany grant full suffrage to women. Canadian women, excluding indigenous women and those in Quebec, gain voting rights.
- **1919** The Netherlands, Belgium, Ukraine, Luxembourg, Sweden, and Belarus grant the vote; white women gain voting rights in the US via the 19th Amendment, which is ratified in 1920.
- **1921** Women in Armenia, Azerbaijan, and Lithuania, gain voting rights; the new voting laws come into effect in Sweden.
- **1931** Spain gives women voting rights.
- **1944** French women are granted suffrage.
- **1946** Italy gives women full voting rights.

◀ **SUFFRAGISTS MARCH IN NEW YORK**
CARRYING PORTABLE SPEAKERS, 1912.

